

How We Ranked Them

A detailed look into the methodology and process followed for the
BT-MDRA India's Best B-schools Survey 2023

WITH SIGNIFICANT IMPROVEMENTS in the number of data points, the 11th edition of BT-MDRA India's Best B-schools Survey 2023—and 24th overall—retains the same fundamentals that it started with in 2013. The ranking provides the most credible and exhaustive rankings of India's Best B-schools based on the most recent data. With the changing needs of time, new rankings have been introduced, such as Top 20 One-year MBAs; Top 10 Edtech platforms providing management courses, and Top 15 Executive Programmes.

As the country's most scientific and methodical ranking of the best business education programmes—the lists have jointly been prepared by *Business Today* and market research firm Marketing & Development Research Associates (MDRA).

Methodology for Full-time MBA/PGDM Ranking

A comprehensive list of B-schools offering full-time, classroom management programmes (PGDM/MBA), and established at least five years ago with a minimum of three graduated batches was prepared. The objective questionnaire was fine-tuned to obtain the latest and most relevant information based on the latest data of 127 attributes, to provide a realistic, updated and accurate picture. More than 2,500 B-schools fulfilling the qualification criteria were contacted, clearly mentioning the deadline and that there was no participation fee. Of these, 273 submitted the data within the timeline, and 272 of them were ranked as one did not fulfill the eligibility criteria.

After collecting the objective data, the four steps of data cleaning, logical checks and validation, back-checks, and audits were conducted. In the first stage, every aspect of the details provided by the B-schools was examined carefully through publicly available information and MDRA's database. In the second stage, verification and audits of the participating B-schools were conducted by MDRA researchers to ensure accuracy and correctness of the data submitted.

About 15 per cent of the B-schools were audited by the research team to verify the authenticity of the submitted data. In the past 11 years, the research team has audited close to 650 campuses to verify various data/information provided by the participating institutes. The research team, while cross-checking the data with the original documents/infrastructure, also made some corrections during the validation and audit process.

The five key parameters of evaluation were: learning experience, living experience, placement performance, selection process, governance and establishment, and future orientation. The scores of these parameters were then summed up to get the total objective score achieved by each institute.

The final ranks were assigned based on the objective data, culled after various levels of cross-validation through multiple sources and physical audits.

Methodology for Other Rankings

● **One-year MBA Ranking:** It has been prepared based on objective data and perception survey of MBA programmes (12-18 months) for working executives. These are full-time, in-classroom programmes with tough admission criteria (work experience, entrance test scores, etc.) that require full-time, rigorous commitment from the students. The objective parameters cover aspects such as admission attractiveness, pedagogy and infrastructure, career growth, return on investment and brand appeal. In this first year of the ranking, a total of nine institutes submitted the objective data of their executive MBA programme within the timeline. However, some who did not submit their data were ranked based on publicly available data. Simultaneously, a perception survey was conducted among various stakeholders, including faculty, students, recruiters and alumni. In total, 190 relevant respondents including 64 students, 43 faculty, 33 alumni, and 50 recruiters were surveyed for the perception survey. Final scores were given by adding both the objective and perception scores in equal proportion, following which the Top 20 institutes offering one-year MBA were ranked.

● **Edtech Ranking:** Edtech ranking was done based